Notes made to prepare for interviews, October 2026

Aladdin Studio from the outside

What public sources show. Clients' AI tools could act on Aladdin under the same controls BlackRock uses for its own business.

Prepared by **Jacob Nikolau** | As of October 19, 2026

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Independent analysis of public sources, done with AI agents. Not produced, reviewed or endorsed by BlackRock.

Executive summary

Clients' AI tools could act on Aladdin under the same controls BlackRock's own business runs on.

Studio is Aladdin's developer and data layer: APIs and events, Aladdin Data Cloud on Snowflake, and developer tools[1]. Many data providers now offer AI tools a way to read their data[2, 3, 4, 5]. Aladdin's APIs can also write, not only read. They post orders and assign compliance rules to portfolios. Access is granted per API, to read or to write. Posting an order runs compliance by default. The caller can turn it off[6]. Whether turning it off needs a separate permission is not public. An AI tool calling these APIs would face Aladdin's existing API access and service controls, but would not automatically inherit Copilot's AI guardrails.

Aladdin will not be alone in letting AI tools act. SimCorp and Clearwater have announced AI agents[7, 8]. BlackRock already uses Copilot across about 100 Aladdin applications, with tools that call production Aladdin APIs. About 100 of its applications carry Copilot. Each Copilot tool matches an Aladdin API already in production[9]. Buyers of investment software say AI is changing what they build[10]. BlackRock has told investors that API calls will grow 17x by 2030[11]. Part 3 sets out this direction: clients' AI tools acting on Aladdin under BlackRock's own controls. It covers what would have to be true, and four pieces of marketing work that would follow.

Limitations of methodology

Public material only: BlackRock web pages, the 54 API specifications inside BlackRock's 11 public Python plugin packages (named `asdk_plugin`), about 125 recordings, SEC filings, procurement notices, GitHub and PyPI. AI agents gathered them; I checked every fact against its document. Some recordings are machine-transcribed, so names and jargon can be misheard. I have no internal product context, so some conclusions may be wrong.

How to read the receipts

Underlined text links to the document behind the fact. Each superscript number points to an entry in Sources, at the end of this document, giving the grade (P, S or T), title, publisher or speaker, and date where known.

■ **P** Primary document: a filing, a specification, a web page or press release, a procurement notice, or code on GitHub or PyPI

■ **S** BlackRock speaker on the record, with the name and title as the recording gives them

□ **T** Third-party report: trade press, or a third party's summary of a primary source

Part 1

What the public record shows

Aladdin is the investment platform BlackRock built for itself and sells to other institutions. Brennan Rosales, an AI Engineering Lead at BlackRock, put the scale this way at a LangChain conference in 2025. "BlackRock is the biggest user of Aladdin, but we also sell and support hundreds of clients globally across 70 countries." The Aladdin organization is "around 7,000 people, with over 4,000 of those being engineers." It maintains "around 100 Aladdin front-end applications"[9]. BlackRock's technology services and subscription revenue was $2.0 billion in 2025[12]. Its 24 percent rise includes Preqin, the private-markets data firm BlackRock bought in 2025[12]. BlackRock sells Aladdin as four platforms that share one data language. They are the Aladdin platform, eFront, Aladdin Wealth and Preqin[13]. Exhibit 1 lists eight products sold across them. Studio is the entry point for people who write code[14].

What BlackRock sells

Exhibit 1. Of eight Aladdin products, Studio is the one for people who write code

Product	What it does
Aladdin	The front-to-back system for public and private markets[15], the same one BlackRock runs internally[9]
Aladdin Wealth	Risk analysis and proposals for advisors[16], with an AI commentary tool since October 2025[17]
eFront	A private-fund platform that now includes Preqin[18], with private credit analytics added in May 2026[19]
Aladdin Studio	**The developer and data layer: APIs and events, Data Cloud, developer tools[1].** For engineers, data analysts and code-curious portfolio managers[14]
Aladdin Data Cloud	Managed data on Snowflake[20], sold as an add-on to Aladdin Enterprise[21], and part of Studio[22]
Aladdin Copilot	A chat assistant available to all Aladdin clients. It gives no investment advice[23]
Aladdin Accounting	Investment accounting and performance[24], with public APIs for valuations, lots and composites[6]
Aladdin Provider	Gives custodians and administrators access to Aladdin. These providers pay BlackRock for it[25]

■ Source: BlackRock product pages[14, 15, 18, 20, 23]; BlackRock AWS release, December 2025[21]; Woodhead[1]; iShares prospectus[25]; the public specifications[6].

Exhibit 2 follows one trade through Aladdin, step by step, as far as the 54 public specifications describe it[6, 26].

Exhibit 2. The public APIs cover a trade from order to NAV, except positions

	1 Order	2 Compliance check	3 Trade	4 Position in the IBOR	5 Lot in the ABOR	6 NAV
Who	Portfolio manager	No one	Trading desk, then operations	Portfolio management, trading, operations[10]	Accounting team[26]	Accounting[26]
Where	Explore what-if[27]	Aladdin Compliance[6]	–	Data Cloud[22, 28]	Aladdin Accounting[6]	Aladdin Accounting
API	`OrderAPI` v1 (stable)	`ComplianceRuleAPI` and `ViolationAPI` v1 (alpha)	`TradeAPI` v2 (alpha)	**None of the 54 is a position API**	`AborLotAPI` v1 (alpha)	`ValuationsAPI` v1 (beta)
Detail	Test (`whatIf`) and compliance (`runCompliance`)[6]	Runs automatically: `runCompliance` is on by default[6]	`BrokerConfirmRoutingAPI` holds where confirms go[6]	Positions appear only as fields in other APIs[6]	Retrieved from the `ledger_a_summary` table[6]	Each valuation carries an exception list[6]

The public specifications cover the trade but hold no position or event API, and do not say in what sequence steps 4 to 6 happen.

The labels in brackets are each specification's stability label: alpha, beta, stable or sunset. Exhibit 5 counts them. ■ Source: the specifications named in each step[6]; Newman[22]; the Explore training recording[27]; the Aladdin Accounting episode[26]; Fivetran[28].

Exhibit 3. Where Studio sits in Aladdin

Who builds	Client engineers	Code-curious portfolio managers	Data analysts	Excel users building reports
BlackRock's applications	**About 100 applications** such as Explore, Dashboard and Risk Radar	**Aladdin Copilot, inside them** each tool matches an Aladdin API already in production		
Aladdin Studio	**Aladdin Studio:** the developer and data layer, whose parts Exhibit 4 shows			
Shared services and data	**Portfolio management, trading, risk, compliance, operations, accounting** reached through the 11 public API domains			
Hosting	Microsoft Azure	Amazon Web Services		
Outside inputs	The client's own and third-party data, loaded into Data Cloud or through the Data eXchange, and vendor data such as prices and ESG research			

CONTROLS IN THE API SPECIFICATIONS

Access set per API
Each API has its own OAuth scopes.

Compliance by default on orders
Posting an order runs compliance unless the caller turns it off, and returns any violations.

For illustrative purposes only. Every box is named in the sources below. The 11 domains are the packages of BlackRock's public software development kit (SDK). The specifications also name Dashboard and Risk Radar. Controls as in Exhibit 14. ■ Source: Rosales at 2:35 and 4:31, for the apps and Copilot[9]; a training recording, for Explore[27]; Woodhead at 4:49, for Studio[1]; the public specifications and SDK[6, 29]; BlackRock's Studio, APIs, ATX, ADX, Data Cloud and Aladdin Risk pages[14, 20, 30, 31, 32, 33]; the Data Cloud launch release[34]; the FY2025 10-K, for hosting[12]; Microsoft, for Azure[35]; data vendors, ICE and Sustainalytics[36, 37].

Exhibit 4. What Studio is made of

WHAT STUDIO OFFERS

APIs
Read and write Aladdin data. Built on Aladdin Graph, BlackRock's firm-wide runtime for APIs and events. Every public specification's ID begins `agraph.<domain>`, for Aladdin Graph

Event-driven workflows
Aladdin tells a program when something happens. Events run on the same Aladdin Graph runtime. No event specification is public

Aladdin SDK
Open-source Python library with typed clients for the APIs and Data Cloud, with login, retries and rate limits built in. A BlackRock plugin builder generates its 11 plugin packages from the specifications

Aladdin Data Cloud
A managed data store on Snowflake, with Fivetran moving the data

Aladdin Compute
Hosted, ready-to-use Python environments

Aladdin Tools for Excel (ATX)
An Excel plugin that pulls Aladdin data into custom reports and analyses

Aladdin Data eXchange (ADX)
Bulk file transfer to and from Aladdin, with standard extracts and loaders

Developer Portal and Data Dictionary
Catalog, guides, field dictionary, notebooks and samples, behind a client login

Governance
"Data, tools, and governance support", including "access management and usage monitoring"

INSIDE A CLIENT'S STUDIO WORKSPACE

Studio UI The screens where tokens, applications and storage are set up

API tokens and OAuth applications Sign-in for the APIs

S3 storage integration File storage for SDK code, set up in a Project

ADC Admin Center The screen for managing Data Cloud datasets

Projects Personal or shared, each holding OAuth applications and storage

Studio Compute sessions Where Aladdin Compute runs SDK code

Studio notifications Alerts sent through Studio's notification APIs

■ Source: BlackRock's Studio page[14]; its APIs, ATX and ADX pages, which list Data Cloud, ADX, Aladdin Compute and ATX as "Additional Aladdin Studio resources"[30, 32, 33]; the 54 public specifications[6], for the ids, the portal link and the Admin Center; the SDK README[29], for the SDK and the workspace; Naik and Kalish[38] and the Aladdin Graph job posting[39], for Aladdin Graph; the plugin builder[40]; Woodhead[1], Goel[41], the Aladdin Risk page[31] and a BlackRock job posting[42], for events and the portal; Fivetran[28]; Snowflake's partner page, for Compute[43]; the developer portal[44]; Studio for Aladdin Risk, for access management[45]. I read Studio Compute sessions as the SDK's name for Aladdin Compute.

Exhibit 5. Two domains hold 127 of the 301 public API operations

Domain	Specs	Operations	Alpha	Beta	Stable	Sunset	Largest APIs by operations
Investment operations	15	**74**	9	4	2	–	PrincipalInterestFactor, CounterPartySettlementInstruction, MiscellaneousCashflow, CouponReset and 11 more
Analytics	9	**53**	–	–	8	1	RiskRule, RiskWorkflow, RiskException, RiskConfig and 5 more
Investment research	5	**41**	5	–	–	–	AnalystCoverage, Criterion, Watchlist, ResearchNote and 1 more
Platform	6	**29**	2	–	4	–	AdcDataset, UserGroup, User, UserGroupPermission and 2 more
Portfolio management	4	**28**	1	–	3	–	CIDWriter, Strategy, CIDReader, CashLadder
Portfolio	3	**23**	1	–	2	–	PortfolioGroup, RestrictedAsset, PortfolioToolkit
Data	1	**15**	–	–	1	–	SecurityCreation
Trading	2	**14**	1	–	1	–	Order, Trade
Compliance	4	**9**	3	–	1	–	ComplianceRuleAssignment, Violation, ComplianceRule, Level
Accounting	4	**8**	2	2	–	–	PortfolioConfiguration, Valuations, CompositeMembership, AborLot
Clients	1	**7**	–	–	1	–	EnrichedCapitalFlow
Total	**54**	**301**	**24**	**6**	**23**	**1**	

■ Source: the 54 Swagger 2.0 specifications inside the 11 `asdk_plugin` packages, version 2.0.0b3, on PyPI[6]. Counts are mine, recomputed from the files. The core `aladdinsdk` package adds four utility APIs (token, subscription, notification and a demo), not counted here. Each specification carries one stability label: alpha, beta, stable or sunset. The four columns count specifications by label. The 54 specifications span 11 domains and 11 PyPI packages. Domain names are BlackRock's own, taken from each specification's id.

The specifications also show how the APIs behave. They set out several controls. An order can be posted as a test (the `whatIf` setting). A compliance check runs by default (`runCompliance`). The response lists any compliance breaches with the order[6]. Some operations take time to finish. Ten specifications offer a way to track them, and 35 operations are marked long-running[6]. The SDK checks back on these operations at set intervals[29]. Risk exceptions record both the date a record is valid and the time it entered the system. A Data Cloud dataset carries a flag that says whether it is bitemporal[6]. Compliance rule assignments move through review states before they are approved[6]. Every request carries an application key and a second credential. The second credential is an OAuth 2.0 token, a client key, or a user name and password[6]. With OAuth, access is granted per API and per action. A typical OAuth scope reads `trading.order_management.order.v1.Order:read`[6]. Developers get their OAuth client ID and secret from Studio's screens[29].

What Studio is

I pulled about 125 recordings. Five BlackRock speakers in them describe Studio or its parts[1, 22, 41, 46, 47]. Exhibit 6 lists each with the title the recording gives. BlackRock's own definition comes from the head of Studio engineering, on Snowflake's podcast in November 2025.

> "So we think about Aladdin today as a platform and Aladdin Studio is essentially the user experience that allows people to think of Aladdin as a platform. It exposes everything Aladdin knows how to do as a set of APIs [and] events. The Aladdin data cloud built on top of Snowflake takes all of that information that's generated through our analytics factory and inside of Aladdin and pushes that into Snowflake. And increasingly we're building a set of developer tools."
>
> — Dave Woodhead, Managing Director and Head of Engineering for Aladdin Studio, Snowflake Data Cloud podcast, published November 11, 2025[1]

Exhibit 6. Five BlackRock executives describe Studio or its parts on the record

Speaker	Title, as the recording gives it	What they add to the definition	Recording
Dave Woodhead	Managing Director and Head of Engineering for Aladdin Studio	Gives the three-part definition quoted above	Snowflake podcast, November 2025[1]
Richard Newman	General Manager, Aladdin Studio	Data Cloud is "part of Studio"; analytics APIs "releasing soon … all part of the Studio umbrella"	Never Done podcast, January 2025[22]
Diwakar Goel	Global Head of Data, Aladdin	Every transaction "via an event, via an API"; Data Cloud "within 15 minutes of latency"	Pensions webinar, 2025[41]
Kunal Khara	Managing Director and Global Head of Aladdin Product	Named "the Aladdin studio estate" a 2024 focus. Described it as programmatic access "at machine scale"	Awards interview, early 2024[46]
Jeff Miller	Managing Director, Global Head of Data Platform and Product Engineering	Data Cloud replaced "flat files … FTP and related transfers"	Snowflake video, May 2026[47]

Source: the recordings cited in the Recording column. Quotations are verbatim from the transcripts. Three of the five transcripts are machine-made, as marked in the Sources section.

Khara, Newman, Goel and Woodhead describe ways for clients to reach Aladdin through code. Only Woodhead names every part, developer tools included[1]. Newman calls the Data Cloud and the analytics APIs part of Studio[22]. Goel says every transaction should be available to clients through an event or an API. He also describes Data Cloud as a near-real-time data store[41]. Khara calls Studio programmatic access to data and reporting[46]. A 2026 job posting calls Studio Developer "Aladdin's extensibility layer"[48]. The role is a product director for Aladdin Studio Developer. Speakers since 2024 describe Studio as APIs and data access. BlackRock can build Studio's positioning on that shared description.

Exhibit 7. Four speakers describe parts of Studio, and only Woodhead names them all

Speaker, date	What they said	Parts they name
Kunal Khara, early 2024	"More users are craving this ability to interact with our data, with their data, with reporting with dashboards on a programmatic basis"[46]	None by name. Programmatic access implies APIs
Richard Newman, January 2025	"Aladdin data cloud specifically comes in, which is part of Studio"; "those analytic APIs … That's all part of the Studio umbrella"[22]	APIs, Data Cloud
Diwakar Goel, 2025	"Every single transaction … via an event, via an API"; "a near real time data store"; exposing "the software and application that we're building"[41]	APIs, events, Data Cloud
Dave Woodhead, November 2025	"It exposes everything Aladdin knows how to do as a set of APIs [and] events. The Aladdin data cloud built on top of Snowflake … developer tools"[1]	APIs and events, Data Cloud, developer tools

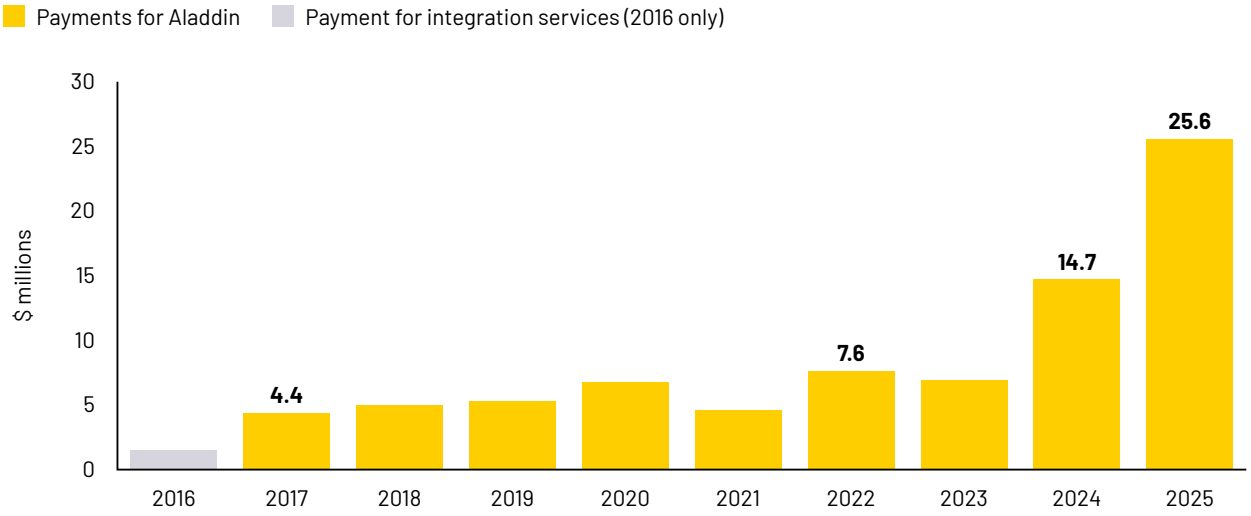
Source: the four recordings cited[1, 22, 41, 46]. Quotations are verbatim. Three of the four transcripts (Khara, Goel and Woodhead) are machine-made, as marked in the Sources section. Goel does not use the name Studio. Miller, in Exhibit 6, speaks only about Data Cloud replacing file transfers, so he is not shown.

Part 2

1. The public record of clients using Aladdin can serve as Studio's proof

BlackRock's Studio page names no client building on Studio[14], and a full-text search of SEC EDGAR finds no filing that mentions Studio[49]. Proof that clients use Aladdin, though, is public. The first kind of record is what clients say and file. In a BlackRock client video, Hans Georgeson praises the Snowflake implementation in Royal London's Aladdin program[50]. He was then chief executive of Royal London Asset Management. JPMorgan Chase's proxy statements report Aladdin payments of $4.4 million to $7.6 million a year from 2017 to 2023, then $14.7 million in 2024 and $25.6 million in 2025[51, 52]. Janus Henderson's 10-K says that in the third quarter of 2025 the firm chose to move its investment management system to Aladdin, "a complex, multi-year initiative"[53].

Exhibit 8. JPMorgan Chase's payments for Aladdin rose from under $8 million a year to $25.6 million in 2025



Source: JPMorgan Chase proxy statements (DEF 14A) filed 2017 to 2026[51, 52]. The chart plots each payment in the year it was made. The grey 2016 bar is a payment for integration services; the figures in the text start with 2017. JPMorgan is also a custodian, so the payments may cover more than a client license. A 2016 trade press report says JPMorgan was connecting to Aladdin for its custody clients[54]. The report is not a JPMorgan or BlackRock document.

A second kind of record is code from a client's engineers. In December 2025 an engineer at a client firm submitted two changes to the open-source SDK[55]. Both help firms that send Aladdin calls through their own enterprise gateway. One rewrites web addresses and one adds custom headers. The BlackRock engineer who co-wrote the SDK's launch post accepted both into the SDK[38, 56, 57]. Public buyers add a third kind of record: procurement notices.

Exhibit 9. BlackRock won the tenders of three public pension bodies

Buyer	Year	Outcome
UK Pension Protection Fund[58]	2025	BlackRock won both parts of the tender, at up to £74.0 million, against the fund's estimate of up to £55 million[58, 59]
Nest (UK)[60]	2023	Nest chose BlackRock's Aladdin over six other bids[60, 61]
US Pension Benefit Guaranty Corporation[62]	2017 and 2023	BlackRock won an investment risk system contract both times, at about the same yearly price[62, 63]

Source: UK Find a Tender[58, 59, 60]; Nest[61]; USAspending.gov[62, 63]. The PPF notice gives BlackRock's Aladdin web page as the supplier's address[58].

None of this proof names Studio. It still backs a Studio pitch, because Studio is sold for building custom applications on Aladdin, and a buyer wants to know that another institution built on the platform and stayed. Proof from one firm counts even when the buyer is a different kind of firm. Some clients are easier to name in public: public pension funds, and firms whose filings or tenders already name BlackRock. They are the natural first subjects for a Studio case study that names the client.

> **What this finding suggests about direction.** A Studio case study that names the client can start with clients whose Aladdin use is already on the record.

2. BlackRock's growth story to investors runs through Studio, but BlackRock rarely names Studio to investors

BlackRock tells investors that API calls will grow fastest, without naming the product behind them. At its 2025 Investor Day, BlackRock forecast four usage measures to 2030. API calls across BlackRock and Aladdin had the fastest forecast growth, 17 times[11]. The forecast covers API calls across BlackRock and Aladdin together, not Studio specifically. Studio is one route through which those calls could grow. No executive said "Studio" on any of the 26 earnings calls from the first quarter of 2020 to the second quarter of 2026[64]. Outside the calls, the only investor-facing mention I found is a single line on a 2023 Investor Day slide[65]. BlackRock's 10-K says technology services fees are generally set by the value of positions on the platform or at a fixed rate. Fees can also depend on subscriptions, client launches (go-lives) and support. The 10-K does not list API calls among its fee terms[12].

Exhibit 10. No BlackRock executive said "Studio" on any of 26 earnings calls, Q1 2020 to Q2 2026

Term	Mentions	Where it came up
Studio	**0**	**Never on a call. The only investor-facing mention found is one line on a 2023 Investor Day slide[65]**
Data Cloud	2	Q3 2022[66] and Q4 2024[67], where it was described as an add-on sold with Aladdin Enterprise
API	1	Q4 2021: "clients are really looking to use both data and APIs"[68]
Copilot	1	Q4 2023: "investments in Aladdin AI copilots"[69]
Citizen developer	0	Never
AI agent or agentic	0	Never

Source: third-party transcripts of BlackRock earnings calls, Q1 2020 to Q2 2026[64]. The tally is mine. The non-zero counts total four mentions in six and a half years, and are approximate. A zero means the term appears in no transcript.

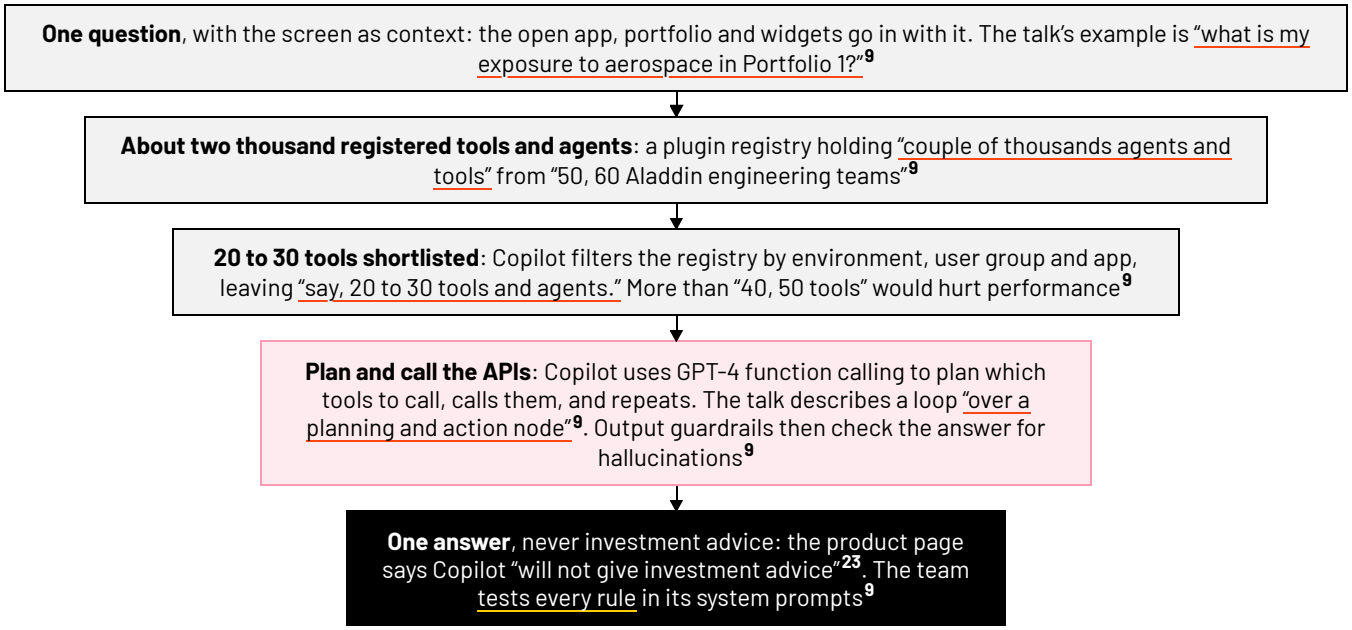
Much of the private-markets data BlackRock has been adding reaches clients through Data Cloud and Explore. BlackRock bought eFront in 2019 and Preqin in 2025. In September 2025 its private markets team described what the two deals brought clients, on a client webinar[70]. Investors "now have access to over 15,000 fund investments within eFront Insight" for benchmarking. Preqin indices "are also available today in Aladdin Explore and our Aladdin Data Cloud capabilities". More than 10 new transaction types were added to Aladdin ("over 10 different transaction types"). They cover commitments, fundings, paydowns and payment in kind (PIK). So Aladdin now records private credit loans directly. The team said it designed its private credit data model with BlackRock's own professionals and "our new colleagues from HPS"[70]. HPS is the credit investment manager BlackRock bought in July 2025[12]. Private credit analytics on Preqin followed in May 2026[19]. Newman, the Studio general manager, names eFront data and Preqin among the data being added to Data Cloud[22].

What this finding suggests about direction. Studio is one route for both of BlackRock's growth bets. It projects API calls across BlackRock and Aladdin to grow 17x by 2030[11]. That is the fastest of the four forecasts it showed investors[11]. Its new eFront and Preqin private-markets data is going into Data Cloud, which is part of Studio[22].

3. Aladdin's AI works only for logged-in users. Data providers let outside AI tools reach their data.

Aladdin Copilot, the AI inside the login, calls Aladdin's production APIs as tools. It draws on a registry of plugins built by Aladdin's engineering teams. The speakers put it at a "couple of thousands agents and tools"[9]. Teams add to the registry in two ways. The first is "to define a tool as kind of mapping one-to-one to an existing Aladdin API already out in production"[9]. The second is to register an agent of their own[9]. Studio "exposes everything Aladdin knows how to do" as APIs and events[1]. Copilot's tools call production Aladdin APIs, and Studio gives clients access to documented Aladdin APIs. Whether the two sets overlap, and by how much, is not public. On BlackRock's podcast, Microsoft's Adrian Crockett said firms building their own copilots need plugins: "There's no copilot without plug-ins"[71]. On the data side, a BlackRock product leader says the team is making sure "the data model itself is structured for agentic use cases"[72].

Exhibit 11. Copilot answers a question by picking from about two thousand tools and agents, then calling production Aladdin APIs



Source: Rosales and Valdez at LangChain Interrupt 2025[9]; the Copilot page[23]. The tool counts are the speakers' own estimates. Quotes come from a machine transcript of the talk, marked as such in Sources.

Exhibit 12 lists what the 11 providers I chose to compare have made public about AI access. Six data and cloud providers offer a connector or an MCP server. Four system-of-record rivals have announced AI features or AI access to their data. Many of the 11 offer an MCP (Model Context Protocol) server, a standard way for outside AI tools to connect. Aladdin has published no such route. Its only public mention of MCP is a job posting[73]. LSEG had 90 customers connected to its MCP server by April 2026[74].

Exhibit 12. Ten of the 11 providers I compared have announced AI features or AI access to their data

Provider	What is public	Source
System-of-record rivals		
SimCorp	Agent Launchpad, announced in 2026, is to offer prebuilt AI agents and let clients build their own on SimCorp One's data layer	SimCorp news[7]
Arcesium	Arcesium added AI features to Aquata, including an MCP server that connects outside AI tools to client data, and launched an AI platform	Arcesium press releases[75, 76]
Clearwater	Clearwater announced CWAN GenAI, with more than 800 AI agents for clients, in November 2025	Clearwater press release[8]
Bloomberg	Bloomberg launched an MCP server for licensed data in September 2026	Bloomberg press release[77]
Data and cloud providers		
FactSet	FactSet runs an MCP server for its data and calls it the first in its market	FactSet press release[3]
LSEG	LSEG has announced a collaboration with Anthropic and an MCP server. It had 90 customers connected to its MCP server by April 2026	LSEG press releases[2, 74]
MSCI	MSCI offers "AI connectors" to its proprietary data	MSCI press release[4]
S&P Global	S&P Global added Credit Ratings to its AI Data Portal in September 2026	S&P Global press release[78]
Snowflake	Snowflake documents an MCP server for Cortex Agents	Snowflake documentation[5]
Databricks	Databricks documents managed MCP servers	Databricks documentation[79]
Aladdin, for comparison		
Aladdin	**A Forward Deploy Engineer posting for Aladdin Data names "Model Context Protocol (MCP), AI agents, and Copilot extensions"**	**BlackRock job posting[73]**

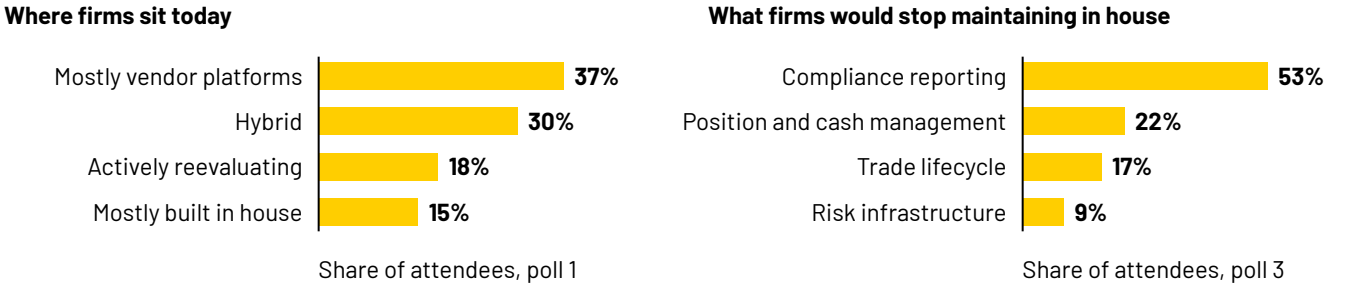
Source: the press releases, documentation and job posting in the Source column, as of October 2026. Aladdin has only a job posting that mentions MCP[73]. State Street is not listed because my sources show no AI feature it offers clients.

> **What this finding suggests about direction.** BlackRock could publish how Copilot's plugin model works: which production APIs each tool calls, which user groups may use each tool, and the tested guardrails that block investment advice[9, 23].

4. At BlackRock's own webinar, two thirds of attendees said they run vendor or hybrid platforms

BlackRock ran a Build vs. Buy webinar for asset managers and polled the attendees. The first poll asked where firms sit today. 37 percent said they run "mostly vendor platforms," 30 percent run a "hybrid," 18 percent are "actively reevaluating," and 15 percent are "mostly built in house"[10]. The second poll asked what is driving the build-or-buy decision. "AI and data demands" led at 42 percent; cost and speed to market tied for second[10]. The third poll asked what they would stop maintaining in house. 53 percent chose compliance reporting[10].

Exhibit 13. Webinar attendees mostly run vendor or hybrid platforms and would stop maintaining compliance reporting in house first



Source: poll results read out on the Build vs. Buy webinar, from the replay's published captions[10].

> "What's the API suite that you have? Are you using connectors to Snowflake or to Databricks? And I think that that part of the RFP has become much more prominent."
>
> — Clark Schafer, Partner, Alpha FMC, on the Build vs. Buy webinar[10]

Alisha Sewdass, BlackRock's Head of Aladdin Solutions Engineering, Americas, gave BlackRock's side on the same webinar. She said clients are making a "move to more of a modular approach"[10]. They want "that backbone foundational data that supports both publics and privates workflows"[10]. They also want "very, very robust APIs that manage the end to end life cycle of a transaction"[10]. Those APIs let clients build "their secret sauce rebalancing tools" on top[10]. On AI, she said, "you need that system of record that underpins anything that AI is built upon." She called a "really defined system of work" the other layer that is "almost equally important"[10]. By that she meant integrated workflows across portfolio management, trading, operations and compliance, governed by operational controls and run on the same data[10].

Rivals sell the same model, a core platform with the client's own builds on top. SimCorp announced wins at AllianceBernstein in February 2026 and Pictet in May 2026. AllianceBernstein keeps its "specialized in-house technology," and Pictet connects its own tools to SimCorp One by API[80, 81]. BlackRock's own August 2026 insight page says the same: "Build vs buy is no longer a binary question"[82].

> **What this finding suggests about direction.** Buyers now ask in RFPs whether they can build on the platform. Studio is BlackRock's answer to that question, so it could lead the API section of a response.

Part 3

Directions to explore

BlackRock could present Studio as the place where a client's own AI tools act on investment data. Calls through Studio would use Aladdin's applicable API permissions and service controls. Copilot's AI-specific controls would not automatically carry over. BlackRock has said parts of this. It sells Aladdin as the system it runs internally[9, 83]. Its speakers have said that the system of record underpins anything built with AI[10], and that the data model is being structured for agentic use[72]. I have not seen BlackRock describe Studio this way.

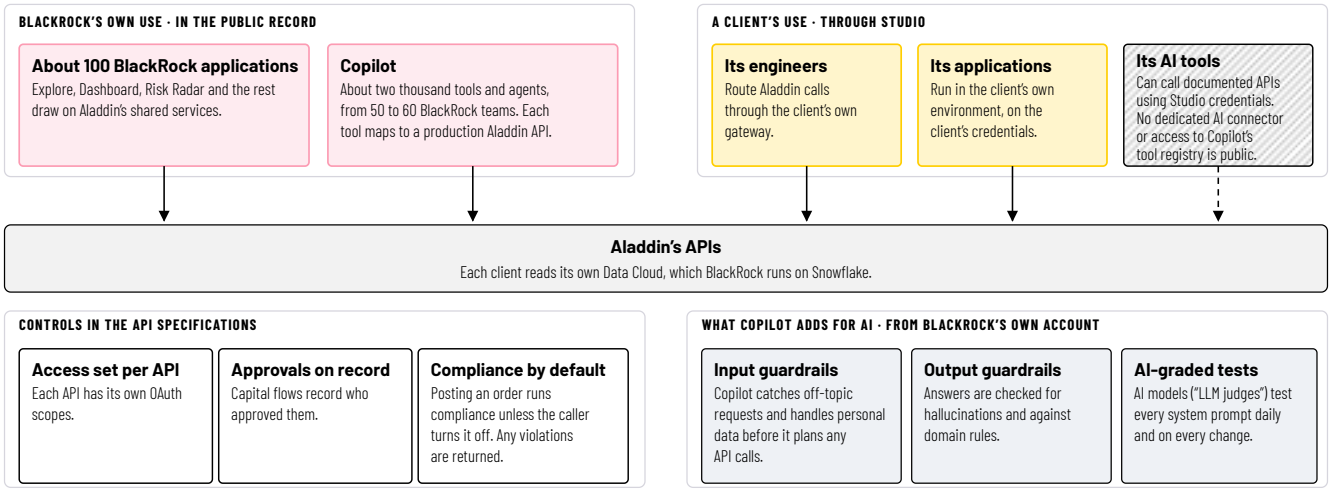
Letting AI tools act is unlikely to stay unique. SimCorp and Clearwater have announced AI agents, Arcesium an AI platform, and others will likely follow[7, 8, 76]. What BlackRock can show is its own use. About 100 of its applications carry Copilot. Each Copilot tool maps to a production Aladdin API. The team that owns each tool sets which user groups can use it[9]. Posting an order runs compliance by default. The caller can turn it off[6]. Whether turning it off needs a separate permission is not public. Copilot's guardrails are tested daily[9]. A client's AI tools could use Aladdin's existing API access and service controls. They would not automatically inherit Copilot's tool-registry rules or AI guardrails. Those would need separate provision or validation. They can call documented APIs with credentials registered in Studio[29]. No dedicated AI connector, or access to Copilot's tool registry, is public.

Buyers say AI is changing what they build. "AI and data demands" led BlackRock's webinar poll at 42 percent as the reason firms are rethinking what to build and what to buy, and buyers now ask about APIs and connectors in RFPs[10]. The poll did not ask whether clients want AI tools that act on Aladdin, and it gives no sample size.

The client base is large. BlackRock serves hundreds of Aladdin clients in 70 countries[9], and its technology services revenue was $2.0 billion in 2025[12]. A 2026 job posting for Aladdin Graph, the team behind the API layer, says it builds for BlackRock and over 200 institutions that rely on its technology[39]. BlackRock sizes Aladdin's addressable market at more than $20 billion[11]. It projects API calls across BlackRock and Aladdin to grow 17x by 2030[11]. My inference is that clients' AI tools, acting through Studio, could become a large source of those calls. How many of those institutions run their own AI tools is not public.

Three things would have to be true for this direction to hold. Clients would have to want AI tools that act, not only ones that answer questions. Their risk teams and regulators would have to accept it, which likely means a person approves each action. And BlackRock would have to make appropriate controls available to external AI tools it did not build.

Exhibit 14. BlackRock's applications and client programs can call Aladdin APIs. Copilot adds AI-specific controls that external tools would not automatically inherit.



■ Solid boxes are in the public record. In the hatched box, calling documented APIs with credentials registered in Studio is public, through the SDK README[29]. A dedicated AI connector and access to Copilot's tool registry are not. The nearest public sign of a connector is a September 2026 Forward Deploy Engineer posting for Aladdin Data that names MCP and AI agents[73]. API access and service controls apply to calls through Aladdin's APIs. Copilot's tool-registry rules and AI guardrails are additional controls used inside Copilot. An external AI tool would not inherit them automatically. Data Cloud, storage and the Data eXchange have their own access controls. Sources: Rosales and Valdez[9], the Studio page[14], the Data Cloud launch release[34], the Copilot page[23], two SDK pull requests[56, 57], the SDK README[29], Aladdin's public API specifications[6], the Data Cloud page[20], Woodhead[1] and Fivetran[28].

Exhibit 15. Four pieces of marketing work to explore, in the order I would start them

	The work	What it is	How to know it worked
1	**An answer for RFPs**	A ready answer to "what APIs do you have, and can we connect to them". It lists the APIs by area, with stability labels. It explains permissions and how a client routes calls through its own gateway. It covers Snowflake and Databricks connectors. It also explains how client programs, including AI tools, can use the documented APIs today, without implying that a dedicated AI-agent connector has been released.	Time to answer the API section of an RFP. Number of RFPs in which buyers score Studio. How many of those are won.
2	**A worked example: an AI-proposed rebalance**	A proposed page and demo in which a client's AI tool suggests a rebalance and submits what-if orders with compliance enabled[6]. The portfolio manager's authorization and subsequent trading are separate workflow steps requiring internal validation. BlackRock has publicly identified rebalancing tools as something clients can build with Aladdin's APIs[10].	Meetings that open on this example; pipeline tagged to it; API calls from clients who build it
3	**One client willing to be named**	One named case study of a client that actually builds with Studio, showing what it built and why. Firms already named in Aladdin filings, tenders, or SDK contributions are candidates to approach, not yet proven Studio case studies.	Named clients sales can cite; deals in which one is cited
4	**How a client's AI tools act on Aladdin**	Once BlackRock validates and decides to offer a dedicated integration, a page explaining how clients' AI tools could use Aladdin capabilities, potentially including tools also used by Copilot, under appropriate user permissions and AI-specific controls.	After launch: the page is published; RFPs and deal reviews get a clear answer on AI connections; API calls from client AI tools

Part 4

What I could not see

I read everything here from outside, with no client login. So this document cannot confirm what clients see. Exhibit 16 follows a prospect's engineer through six steps, from first hearing about Studio to getting help. For each step it records what is public today and what opens only to qualified prospects and clients. I could read the pages, unpack the specifications and read the SDK's code. I could not run anything, test what a client receives, or open the catalog and the API guides with their notebooks and code samples. Where this document describes the catalog, the guides or what a client receives, it relies on what sources say.

Exhibit 16. At each step, what is public today and what opens only after qualification

Step	Public today	After qualification	Receipt
Hear	Podcasts, webinar replays, client videos and conference talks on BlackRock's site and partner channels	The invitation-only Aladdin Client Forum and the Solutions Engineering team	the Never Done podcast[84], the Big Little Questions video series[85], client story video[50], webinar replay[10], Woodhead[1], Rosales and Valdez[9], Client Forum page[86], Solutions Engineering job posting[87]
Read	The Studio page ("Create & automate," "Make Aladdin your own," "Align internally & externally") and the APIs page, which promises "dozens of Aladdin APIs"	The Developer Portal and the API framework guides	Studio page[14], APIs page[30], developer portal[6, 44], job posting[42]
See the catalog	The 54 specifications, in the PyPI add-on packages and linked on GitHub	The API catalog and the Data Dictionary	asdk_plugin packages[6], plugin builder[40], APIs page[30], developer portal[44]
Try	Nothing to run: no public sandbox or trial is offered	Studio Compute (hosted Python), an API token or OAuth app "registered via Studio UI", the client's Aladdin address	SDK README[29]
Build	The open-source SDK on GitHub and PyPI, with a detailed README, sample code and demo notebooks; the plugin builder	A client host and credentials, which the SDK needs for every call	SDK README[29], PyPI history[88], plugin builder[40]
Get help	SDK changes from outside developers, reviewed and merged by a BlackRock engineer. On the Studio page, "Book a meeting" and "Download the brochure".	Jupyter notebooks and code samples from the API guides	SDK change for enterprise gateways[56], SDK change for extra HTTP headers[57], Studio page[14], APIs page[30]

■ Source: the pages and repositories in the Receipt column, read with no account or login, October 2026. The After qualification column is what those sources say a client receives. I could not test it, because the developer portal opens only after a client login[6, 44].

The SDK is the one piece of Studio a prospect can install before any conversation. Its README shows it is built for firms with strict IT controls. It runs in three modes: "a developer's local machine," "Aladdin Studio Compute sessions" and a test mode. It keeps a password it asks for in the operating system's credential manager. It has settings for firms that call "the Aladdin APIs via an enterprise API management platform such as Azure API Management"[29].

Exhibit 17. Data platforms open to any developer, investment platforms like Studio mostly to clients

2: Fully public or self-serve 1: Partial or after sign-up or approval 0: None, or closed to non-clients

Platform	Public docs	API catalog	Trial or sandbox	First API call without a contract	Sample code	Community or marketplace	AI connector	Call to action
Investment platforms								
Bloomberg	1	0	1	0	2	1	2	1
Aladdin Studio	**1**	**1**	**0**	**0**	**1**	**1**	**0**	**0**
State Street	1	0	1	0	1	1	0	1
Arcesium	0	0	1	0	0	1	2	1
SimCorp	0	0	0	0	0	1	0	0
Clearwater	0	0	0	0	0	1	0	0
Data and cloud platforms								
Snowflake	2	2	2	2	2	2	2	2
Databricks	2	2	2	2	2	2	2	2
LSEG	1	2	1	1	2	2	2	1
FactSet	2	2	1	0	2	1	2	1
MSCI	1	2	0	0	1	1	2	1

For the AI connector score: 2 means a connector that outside AI tools can use, such as an MCP server. 1 means one announced or in limited release. 0 means none, or an assistant that works only inside the vendor's own platform. For the Call to action score: 2 means a developer can sign up and start alone, 1 a trial or access request, and 0 sales contact only.

Source: my test of each platform's public pages[2, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 14, 29, 30, 75, 76, 77, 79, 89, 90, 91, 92, 93, 94, 95, 96, 97, 98, 99, 100, 101, 102, 103, 104], no accounts or payments, October 8, 2026. Bloomberg and Clearwater may score lower than they deserve, because some of their pages blocked automated access.

Exhibit 17 puts Studio beside 10 platforms that may compete with Aladdin for certain uses. It scores each from 0 to 2 on eight things a developer with no client relationship can reach. The scores follow how each vendor sells. Investment platforms score low because a first API call needs a contract or a relationship, at Aladdin as at Bloomberg, State Street, SimCorp, Clearwater and Arcesium. Studio scores in line with them, but trails Bloomberg and Arcesium on AI connectors (0 against 2). Snowflake and Databricks sell to developers directly and score highest. LSEG and FactSet come next. FactSet and MSCI allow a first API call only for licensed clients[89, 98].

About this document

This is an independent analysis compiled from public sources. The sources include BlackRock product pages, investor presentations, SEC filings, a fund prospectus, procurement notices, press releases and job postings. They also include public code and packages on GitHub and PyPI, other vendors' product and developer pages, blogs and trade press. Finally, they include transcripts of recordings and earnings calls in which BlackRock speakers take part. BlackRock did not produce, review or endorse this analysis. Facts are as of October 19, 2026, unless an exhibit or a source entry gives another date.

AI agents pulled the pages, unpacked the packages, transcribed the recordings that had no published transcript or captions, and drafted the text. I checked each claim against the document or recording it cites.

Underlined text links to the document behind each fact. Superscripts point to the Sources section, which follows this page and gives each source's grade (P, S or T), title, publisher or speaker, and date where known.

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Sources

Sources are numbered in the order they are first cited. The letter after each number gives its grade. P is a primary document. S is a BlackRock speaker on the record, with name and title as the recording gives them. T is a third-party report. For recordings, each entry gives the minute and second at which each quoted passage begins. "Machine transcription" means speech-to-text software run locally on the downloaded audio. "Auto-captions" means YouTube's captions. Both can mishear names and jargon. Inside quotations, the only correction made was to the spelling of proper names the captions got wrong.

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